



FIRST SEMESTER, 2026-2027

Course Handout (Part II)

Date: 01-08-2026

In addition to part I (General course Handout for all courses appended to the time table) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No.: **HSS F235**
Course Title: **Introductory Philosophy**
Instructor-in-charge: **Anupam Yadav**

6168 R, New Academic Building

1. Course Description

An overview of major philosophical traditions from the Western and Indian worlds. The course traces the nature and purpose of philosophy from classical Greek thought through modern rationalism, empiricism, and existentialism before turning to the classical Indian schools.

2. Scope and Objective

A critical survey of major Western and Indian philosophical viewpoints, from antiquity to contemporary thought. The course aims to equip students with the tools to critically evaluate philosophical arguments and to appreciate their relevance to questions of knowledge, ethics, and selfhood in human life.

3. Course Learning Objectives

Upon completion of the course students will have

- An understanding of the various philosophical schools of Indian and Western traditions.
- A critical and comparative grasp of the philosophical viewpoints & debates.
- An ability to build theoretical constructions and extend philosophical thinking to other disciplines.
- An ability to practice the habit of thinking rationally and critically in leading an ethical and meaningful life

4. Text books:

1. Thilly, F., A History of Philosophy, Central Book Depot, Allahabad, revised edition, 2007, reprint: 2014.
2. Sharma, C.D., A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy, Motilal Banarsidass, New Delhi, 2009 edition.

Reference books:

1. Puligandla, R., Fundamentals of Indian Philosophy, D.K. Print World (P), New Delhi: 1997.
2. Hiriyanna, M., The Essentials of Indian Philosophy, Motilal Banarsidass, New Delhi, 2008 edition.

5. Course Plan:

Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference	Learning Outcomes
1. Introduction, Nature of Philosophizing,	L 1.1 - 1.3 1.1 The subject matter and act of philosophizing.	Introduction, TB1	Getting familiar with the subject-matter of philosophy and the act of





Traditional divisions of Philosophy, Relation between philosophy, science, and religion.	1.2 The traditional divisions of the discipline - Philosophy 1.3. Relation between philosophy, science, and religion	Introduction, TB1	philosophizing, knowing the divisions within the subject and understanding the linkages between philosophy, science and religion.
2. Greek Philosophy before Socrates, Plato on knowledge and ideas, virtues and society, Aristotle's Criticisms of Plato	L 2.1 - 2.4 2.1. The beginning of philosophy in pre-Socratic Greek thinkers and Socrates 2.2 Plato on knowledge and Ideas 2.3 Plato on virtues, self, and society 2.4 Aristotle's criticisms of Plato's theory of Ideas	TB1, Ch. 1 TB1, Ch. 1 TB1, Ch. 3 TB1, Ch. 3	Understanding the philosophical questions in in pre-Socratic thinkers and Socrates. Knowing Plato's idealism, theory of knowledge and his views on virtues, self and society. Also learning Aristotle's metaphysics and criticisms against Plato.
3. Continental Rationalism, Rene Descartes and Spinoza	L 3.1 – 3.4 3.1 Continental Rationalism 3.2 – 3.4 Rene Descartes: what do we know with certainty, the self as mind, God, mind-body dualism, external bodies and Spinoza's metaphysics	TB Ch. 12 TB1, Ch. 12	Learning the genesis of philosophy in modern period, especially the foundation of rationalism in Descartes' methods, knowing the nature of mind, God and external bodies in Descartes and the ways mind-body dualism is understood in Descartes and Spinoza.
4 British Empiricism: Tenets of empiricism in Locke, Berkeley and Hume	L 4.1 – 4.4 4.1- 4.2 Locke's empiricism, views on knowledge and Berkeley's subjective idealism and rejection of abstract ideas 4.3 - 4.4 Origin and nature of knowledge, skepticism, problems of substance and cause.	TB1, Ch. 13 TB1, Ch. 13	Understanding the concept of empiricism, learning the nature and classification of knowledge and Humean skepticism.
5 Questions of Ethics in Kant, Bentham and Mill	L 5.1 - 5.4 5.1 Nature and scope of Ethics 5.2 Kant on duty 5.3 – 5.4 Bentham and Mill's	 TB1, Ch. 16 TB1, Ch. 19	Understanding the nature of ethics: acts and judgments in the thoughts of Hume, Kant, Bentham and Mill.





	utilitarianism		
6. Existentialism: the main characteristics and the idea of ethical self	L 6.1 – 6.4 6.1-6.3 The problems of existence in main existentialist thinkers like Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger 6.4 The idea of ethical self in existentialism	TB1, Ch. 20 TB1, Ch. 20	Knowing existentialism as a way of life, understanding the issues of existence and the nature of ethical self
7. Introduction to various Indian philosophical systems, Vedas and Upanisadas, Atman and Brahman	L 7.1 – 7.3 7.1 Various Indian philosophical systems 7.2 Vedas and Upanisadas 7.3 Atman and Brahman	TB2, Ch. 1 TB2, Ch. 1 TB2, Ch. 1	To be familiar with the Indian philosophical thought, knowing the nature of Vedas and Upanishadas and the major philosophical themes of Atman and Brahman
8. Samkhya and Yoga	L 8.1 – 8.4 8.1 – 8.2 Samkhya: Prakrti and Purusa; the theory of evolution 8.3 – 8.4 Yoga: chitta and its vritties, Astanga yoga	TB2, Ch. 9 TB2, Ch. 10	Knowing Sankhya's metaphysical position on reality, the fundamental division between Prakrti and Purusa and understanding the Yoga system of thought and its relation to Sankhya.
9. Vaishesika and Nyaya	L 9.1 – 9.3 9.1 Atomism of Vaishesika and Categories 9.2 – 9.3 Nyaya: sources of knowledge and validity and comparison between Aristotle and Nyaya's inference	TB2, Ch. 11 TB2, Ch. 12	Understanding the ontology given in Vaishesika system and epistemology propounded in Nyaya.
10. Vedanta system: Non-dualism of Shankara, Shankara on the absolute, self, and world. Ramanuja: qualified non-dualism	L 10.1 – 10.3 10.1 Shankara on the Absolute, self, and world 10.2 Ramanuja's qualified non-dualism and self 10.3 Comparative analysis of Shankara and Ramanuja's Vedanta	TB2, Ch. 15 TB2, Ch. 18	Understanding the philosophy of Vedanta in Shankara and Ramanuja and a comparative analysis of the two.
11. Heterodox Systems: Jainism and Buddhism	L 11.1 - 11.4 11.1 To know about the heterodox system of thoughts 11.2 Buddhism: four noble	TB2, Ch. 5 TB2, Ch. 4	Understanding the heterodox systems of Indian philosophy, the thought systems of Buddhism and Jainism and





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	truths, doctrine of dependent origination and nirvana 11.3 Jainism: jiva, ajiva and anekantavada 11.4 Concluding note on Indian philosophical systems, general aims and relevance	TB2, Ch. 1 RF1, Ch. 1	a general understanding and relevance of the subject to other disciplines.
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6. Evaluation Scheme:

EC No.	Evaluation Component	Duration	Weightage	Date, Time & Venue	Remarks
1	Mid Semester Test	90 Minutes	30	As per AUGSD Timetable	CB
2	Assignment/Case Study/Presentation	-	30	To be announced	OB
3	Comprehensive Examination	180 Minutes	40	As per AUGSD Timetable	CB

Attendance Policy: Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components.

Chamber Consultation Hour: To be announced in the class.

Makeup Policy: Make-up components will be allowed only for mid-semester and comprehensive exams provided there is a valid documentary proof to support the case.

Instructor-in-charge
HSS F235



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